



THE LANGUAGE GAZETTE

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 Editorial
Writtern by
Mr.Soham Kakade.

04 Verbal Voyages
A Lingusitic Riddle by
Team Ewan

02 Dans la mine (part-2)
Marathi translation by
Mr. Ravindra Abhyankar

05 Je ne veux pas oublier
Written & english translation by
Ms. Vaibhavi Waghela

03 La llorona (Part-2)
English translation by
Ms. Jui Paranjape

06 Zen Moments
Written by Aida Mitsuo (相田 みつを)
English translation by
Ms. Rucha Kulkarni



TABLE OF CONTENTS

07	Wabi-Sabi Written & english translation by Ms. Shivani Sambus	10	അസ്സുറോ & സ്കൈ ബ്ലൂ: ഇറ്ലിയും അർജന്റീനയും പങ്കുവെക്കുന്ന ഗംഭീരത Written & english translation by Mr. Phillip Goerge
08	Eine Nostalgische Reise Written & english translation by Mr. Omkar Dhuraji	11	Prognose: Dit is wat de energietransitie betekent voor de elektriciteitsprijzen Written & english translation by Ms. Aisha Busari
09	Yasuke: A african Samurai who shaped the japanese history Written by Team Ewan	12	Answers Answers for Crossword & Word Detective

Artificial Intelligence is not an IF but a WHEN



Machine translation (MT) has made significant strides in recent years, with tools like Google Translate becoming household names. However, despite its advancements, there are compelling reasons why machine translation will not replace human translators. Here's a look at some key points that highlight the irreplaceable value of human translators. But translators should take advantage of the new trends and software to make the work faster and less stressful. In this two-part editorial we will be discussing why ML cannot replace Human Translator along with how a translator can leverage the technology to hone his skills and proficiency in freelancing.

To me, the most important aspect on this topic is confidentiality. Machine Translations or AI uses your source language, match it will the machine memory and give you the best output while websites such as Google or Bing translator uses the same flow but also possibly storing the document they are translation keeping the loop open with no control. This may result in unauthorized access of your critical information to public domain. And that is why HUMAN TRANSLATION WILL ALWAYS BE THERE!

Apart from this, I think following are the different reasons, ML will not replace Humans entirely

1. Understanding Context

One of the primary limitations of machine translation is its inability to grasp context. While MT can translate words and phrases, it often struggles with nuanced meanings, idiomatic expressions, and cultural references. Human translators, on the other hand, understand the subtleties of language and can interpret the intent behind the words. For example, translating a phrase like "kick the bucket" literally would lead to confusion, but a human translator knows it means to die.

2. Cultural Sensitivity

Language is deeply intertwined with culture. Machines lack the ability to understand cultural nuances and the emotional weight behind certain phrases. This can lead to translations that are technically correct but culturally inappropriate. A human translator can navigate these complexities, ensuring that the translation resonates with the target audience and respects cultural norms.

3. Creativity and Style

Translation is not just about converting words; it's also about conveying style and emotion. Literary works, poetry, and marketing materials often require a creative touch that machines simply cannot replicate. For instance, a marketing slogan needs to be catchy and impactful, something that a machine might miss. Human translators can infuse creativity into their work, capturing the essence and tone of the original text.

4. Handling Complex Texts

Machine translation excels with straightforward, factual content but falters with complex texts that require deeper understanding. Legal documents, technical manuals, and medical records often contain specialized terminology and intricate structures that demand a human touch. Human translators can ensure accuracy and clarity, which is crucial in fields where misinterpretation can have serious consequences.

5. Emotional Intelligence

Language is often a reflection of human emotions. Machines lack emotional intelligence and cannot interpret the feelings behind words. This is particularly important in sensitive translations, such as those involving personal letters or therapeutic materials. Human translators can empathize with the content and convey the appropriate emotional tone, which is vital for effective communication.

6. Continuous Learning and Adaptation

Languages are constantly evolving, with new phrases and expressions emerging regularly. Human translators are adept at keeping up with these changes, while machines require constant updates and training to adapt. This ongoing learning process allows human translators to stay relevant and provide translations that reflect current language use.

7. Quality Assurance

Despite the speed and efficiency of machine translation, the quality of the output can be inconsistent. Errors can occur, and without a human to review and edit the translation, these mistakes can go unnoticed. Human translators not only produce higher quality translations but also provide an essential layer of proofreading and editing to ensure accuracy.

8. Ethical Considerations

In fields such as law and medicine, ethical considerations are paramount. Machine translations can lead to serious ethical issues if sensitive information is mishandled or misinterpreted. Human translators are trained to handle confidential information responsibly and understand the ethical implications of their work.

Soham Shripad Kakade
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SPECIAL ISSUE



Explore the significance of colour blue and how it shapes a cultural relationship between Argentina and Italy



Unveil the extraordinary tale of Yasuke, the African samurai whose remarkable journey led him to the heart of feudal Japan.





Dans la Mine

Part 2

Un directeur intervient. « C'est Morin. Il a travaillé chez nous pendant près de soixante ans. Qu'est-ce que c'est que cette histoire de passage, Morin ? Il y a un passage entre la galerie 4 de la Charonne et la galerie 3 du puits Guillaume ! Ce n'est pas large, mais on peut y passer. J'y ai passé cent fois quand j'étais gamin ! On m'envoyait chercher de la bière par là parce qu'on ne risquait pas de rencontrer le porion ! On a mis un mur, depuis, du côté du puits Guillaume, mais qu'est-ce que c'est que ça ! Quatre briques à démolir !

Impossible, dit l'ingénieur. A cet endroit-là, c'est du roc !

Justement, monsieur l'ingénieur. Ça date de l'explosion de 95. Le roc est fendu. Ça a laissé une espèce de crevasse. Je vous dis que j'y ai passé cent fois !

Vous êtes sûr de ce que vous dites ? Bon. Rémy, téléphonez au puits Guillaume. Dites- leur d'avoir une cage prête à nous descendre. Faites venir les docteurs, les ambulances, tout. Morin, venez avec moi. »

Il le pousse dans une voiture, s'assieds à côté de lui et part à toute vitesse. Le vieux parle, parle sans arrêt.

« J'avais douze ans, vous comprenez. J'étais le plus petit de l'équipe. J'allais chercher de la bière, deux, trois fois par jour. Il y avait le grand Juliat- sa sœur tenait la cantine du puits Guillaume. Pour une bande de soiffards, c'était une bande de soiffards ! Il faut dire que c'était une sale galerie, la galerie 4. C'était la plus profonde, dans ce temps-là. La poussière qu'on avalait ! »

Dans la galerie 3 du puits Guillaume, le vieux marche sans hésiter à la tête de l'équipe de sauvetage.

« Il y a un tournant, juste après l'escalier de fer. Voilà ! Je vous l'ai bien dit : il y a un mur dz brique. »

Le mur sonne creux.

« Démolissez », dit l'ingénieur.

A la lumière des lampes électriques, le passage apparaît noir, étroit, tortueux ; une crevasse entre deux rocs.

‘Vous voyez ! dit le vieux, triomphant. Au bout, on tourne à droite. L’escalier de fer est à dixmètres. Regardez, monsieur l’ingénieur : je peux encore y passer !

Non, dit l’ingénieur. Pas à votre âge, Morin.J’y vais. Restez ici. Et vous, les autres, attendez.

Je vais avec vous, » dit le docteur.

Ils disparaissent. Les autres attendent. Personne ne dit rien. Dix minutes passent.Un quart d’heure. Vingt minutes.

Devant le puits Guillaume, la foule attend, muette, anxieuse,oppressée. Les femmessanglotent.

«Regardez ! dit l’une d’elles.On met le drapeau. »

Un drapeau tricoloremonte lentement au mât. Tous le suivent des yeux, silencieusement. Si le drapeau s’arrête à la moitié du mât, c’est que les nouvelles sont mauvaises.

Il monte lentement. Les gens retirent leurs souffles.Il arrive à la moitié du mât. Il continueàmonter et flotte joyeusement au soleil.

On a porté le vieux Morin en triomphe. Ça était le plus beau jour de sa vie.

Marathi translation on next page



भाषांतर
खाणीमध्ये
भाग-२

“अहो साहेब आपले मोरें आजोबा आहेत”. एक पर्यवेक्षक म्हणाले. “इथे पन्नास साठ वर्षे काम केलंय त्यांनी..सांगा मोरें आजोबा, ही दुसऱ्या मार्गाची काय कहाणी आहे ?”

“शारोनचा चार नंबरचा बोगदा आणि गिऱ्योमचा तीन नंबरचा बोगदा यांच्यामधून जाणारा एक मार्ग आहे. फारसा रुंद नाहीये तो..पण एखादा माणूस त्यातून घुसून जाऊ शकतो. पोरगेलासा असताना मी त्या मार्गाने शेकडो वेळा गेलेलो आहे...मला बियर आणायला पाठवायचे. आणि मुकादमाचा ससेमिरा चुकावा म्हणून नेहमीचा मार्ग सोडून मी त्या तिथून असंख्य वेळा गेलोय. नंतर तिथे गिऱ्योम बोगद्याजवळ भिंत बांधली. पण त्या ठिकाणी फक्त चारच विटा फोडायला लागतील. आणि ते काही फार कठीण नाही!”

-“ निव्वळ अशक्य !” इंजिनियर साहेब म्हणाले, “तिथे तर खडक आहे”

-“अगदी बरोबर आहे इंजिनियर साहेब. पण ती '९५ च्या स्फोटाच्या वेळची गोष्ट आहे. तो खडक आता नामशेष झाला आहे त्यामुळे तिथे आता एक मोठी भेग पडली आहे. आत्ताच नाही का मी म्हणालो की त्या तिथून मी असंख्य वेळा गेलोय !”

-“ आता तुम्ही जे सांगत आहात त्यावद्दल तुमची खात्री आहे ना ? ठीक आहे. रेमी , गिऱ्योम बोगद्यात फोन करून त्यांना सांगा की आम्हाला खाली येण्यासाठी एक लिफ्ट तयार ठेवा. डॉक्टर , रुग्णवाहिका सारे तयार असूद्यात... मोरें आजोबा चला आमच्याबरोबर.”

त्यांनी आजोबांना एका वाहनात ढकलले आणि स्वतः त्यांच्या शेजारी बसले आणि सारेजण त्वरेने निघाले. आजोबांची अखंड बडबड सुरू झाली. “ मी बारा वर्षांचा होतो....काय, ऐकताय ना तुम्ही?.....त्या संबंध गटात मीच तरुण होतो दिवसातून दोन तीन वेळा मी बियर आणायला जायचो. तेव्हा एक थोरला ज्युलिया होता ना त्याची बहीण गिऱ्योम बोगद्याजवळचं कॅटीन पहायची.. दारुड्यांच्या एका टोळीला ती पुरून उरायची. आणि हे पण सांगितले पाहिजे तुम्हाला, की ती जी चार नंबरची गॅलरी होती ना ती अगदी बेकार होती. त्या काळातसुद्धा ती अत्यंत खोल होती. आणि हो , आम्ही गिळायचो बरं का तो धुरळा.”

आत्मविश्वासपूर्वक दमदार पावले टाकणारे आजोबा गिऱ्योम बोगद्याच्या तीन नंबरच्या गॅलरीत चालणा-या त्या बचाव गटाचे नेतृत्व करीत होते. आणि चालता चालता ते बोलतही होते -

“त्या लोखंडी जिऱ्याच्या नंतर लगेचच एक वळण आहे....आणि ती पहा..मी म्हणालो होतो ना ती विटांची भिंत.”

ती भिंत थोडी ठोकून पाहिल्यावर ती पोकळ असल्याचे जाणवले.

“फोडा” इंजिनियर साहेब म्हणाले.

हेल्मेटवरच्या दिव्यांच्या उजेडात अगदी चिंचोळा, त्रासदायक असू शकणारा अंधारा असा एक मार्ग सा-यांना दिसू लागला. दोन खडकांमधली ती भेगही नजरेस पडली.

“पहा” अत्यानंदाने मोरें आजोबा ओरडले. “ पलिकडच्या टोकाला आपल्याला उजवीकडे वळायचे आहे. लोखंडी जिना दहा मीटर्सवर आहे. इंजिनियर साहेब बघा ! अजूनही मी जाऊ शकेन तिथून !”

“ नाही आजोबा. तुमच्या वयाच्या लोकांसाठी नाही आहे हा रस्ता. मी जातो तिथे! तुम्ही आणि बाकी सारेजण इथेच वाट पहात थांबा.”

“मी येतोय तुमच्याबरोबर” अस म्हणून डॉक्टर निघाले त्यांच्या बरोबर....

ते अंधारात दिसेनासे झाले. बाकी सारे मागेच वाट पहात थांबले. सर्वजण गप्प होते..कोणीही काहीही बोलत नव्हते.



दहा मिनिटे संपली, पंधरा मिनिटे उलटली, वीस निनिटे पार झाली....

गिऱ्योम बोगद्याच्या तोंडाशी अस्वस्थ, तणावपूर्ण, मूक अशा लोकांची खूपच गर्दी जमली होती. गर्दीतील स्त्रीवर्ग हुंदके देत होता. त्यातलीच एकजण ओरडली – “ बघा बघा...झेंडा फडकावताहेत का ? ” एक तिरंगी झेंडा सावकाशपणे ध्वजस्तंभावर चढविला जात होत. सर्वजण गंभीर शांततेत त्या झेंड्याकडे पहात होते. जर दुःखद वार्ता असेल तर झेंडा अर्ध्यावर थांबायचा. झेंडा संधपणे वर जात होता. सर्वांचे श्वास रोखलेले होते. झेंडा अर्ध्यापर्यंत आला आणि सावकाश आणखी वर जाऊ लागला. शेवटी कडक उन्हात, उंच आकाशात तो झेंडा डौलाने पडकू लागला. .

सगळ्यांनी अत्यानंदाने आजोबांना उचलून घेतले. तो त्यांच्या आयुष्यातील सर्वोत्तम दिवस होता.

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LA LLORONA

part-2

El hombre está triste porque desea tener a sus hijos con él, pero esto no es posible. Por eso, le envía dinero a la mujer cada mes para mantener a los niños.

La mujer no está preocupada. Ella tiene su casa, a sus hijos y todas sus posesiones. Recibe dinero mensualmente para cuidar de ellos y no necesita al hombre. La mujer sigue adelante con su vida.

Un día, la mujer se entera de que el hombre tiene una nueva familia: una nueva esposa y un hijo. Al saber esto, la mujer se enoja.

El hombre rico escribe una carta a su exesposa, informándole que se mudará a una nueva casa pronto y que desea llevarse a los hijos para vivir con él y su nueva familia. En la carta, el hombre dice que, una vez que tenga a los niños, ella dejará de recibir dinero. Además, en la carta afirma que ella es una madre terrible que solo quiere el dinero y no a sus hijos. La carta es entregada a la mujer por un sirviente.

Al recibir y leer la carta, la mujer se enfurece. Está furiosa porque el hombre quiere llevarse a sus hijos y detener el flujo de dinero. Aunque no está tan preocupada por los hijos, está muy preocupada por el dinero que necesita para mantener su casa y a sus sirvientes. No quiere trabajar.

La mujer no quiere ceder su dinero a la nueva esposa ni entregar a sus hijos. Se siente atrapada y sin opciones.

Esa noche, la mujer lleva a sus hijos al río cercano a la casa. Camina con ellos en el agua fría, que los asusta. Los niños temen a su madre, quien está actuando de manera extraña y desquiciada por su furia hacia el hombre.

De repente, la mujer comienza a sumergir a los niños en el agua. A pesar de sus intentos de moverse y escapar, no pueden. La mujer es mucho más fuerte que ellos, y pronto los niños están muertos. La mujer ha matado a sus propios hijos.

Al ver a sus hijos muertos, la mujer se llena de arrepentimiento. No quería matar a sus hijos; su intención era vengarse de su exesposo. Llorando por lo que ha hecho, grita:

—¡Ay, mis hijos!

Desesperada y llena de tristeza, la mujer avanza más en el río y desaparece bajo el agua.

Cuando el abuelo del niño cuenta la historia de la mujer hermosa, el niño escucha con atención y encuentra la historia interesante. Sin embargo, al final de la narración, el abuelo siempre repite algo que lo aterra:

Nieto, debes tener cuidado cuando camines cerca del río. La mujer hermosa no está muerta; es un fantasma que llora por sus hijos. Ella busca a sus hijos y se lleva a los niños que andan solos por la noche.

Esa noche, el niño camina solo, pensando en la historia de su abuelo y sintiendo miedo. La calle que lleva a su casa pasa junto al río. El niño acelera el paso al pasar por el río, temeroso pero también curioso. Al mirar el agua, ve una figura flotante. Es una mujer muy bella con cabello negro.

—¡Ay, mis hijos! ¿Dónde están mis hijos?

El niño reconoce a La Llorona y se asusta mucho.

—¡Ay, mis hijos! ¿Dónde están mis hijos?

El niño corre con todas sus fuerzas, pero no lo suficiente. Una mano fría lo agarra. La Llorona lo arrastra al río y lo sumerge en el agua fría, mientras sigue llorando:

—¡Ay, mis hijos!

LA LLORONA

part-2

The man was deeply saddened because he wanted to have his children with him, but it was not possible. So, he sent money to his ex-wife every month to support them.

The woman, on the other hand, was not particularly bothered by her husband's departure. She had her house, her children, and all her beautiful possessions. Moreover, she received financial support each month to care for her children.

However, one day, she learned that the man had a new family—he had a new wife and a new son. This news greatly disturbed her. She was not upset about the man's new family per se, but rather that he wanted to take her children and stop sending money. Her primary concern was the loss of financial support, not the welfare of her children. She did not want to share her money or her children with the new wife and felt she had limited options.

One night, driven by her anger and desperation, the woman took her children to the river near her house. The water was icy cold, and the children were terrified. They feared their mother, who was acting strangely due to her rage against the man.

In a fit of madness, the woman began to drown her children in the freezing water. Despite their struggles, the children were unable to escape her grip. Soon, they were dead. The woman looked at their lifeless bodies and was immediately filled with regret. She had never intended to harm her children; her goal had been to exact revenge on her ex-husband. Overcome with grief, she cried out:

"Oh, my children!"

In her sorrow, the woman waded deeper into the river and vanished beneath the surface.

The boy's grandfather had often told him the story of the beautiful woman, and he listened with rapt attention. However, the grandfather always ended the tale with a warning that deeply frightened the boy:

Be careful when walking near the river. The beautiful woman is not truly dead; she is a ghost who mourns her children. She searches for them and takes away children who wander alone at night."

One night, as the boy walked home alone, he recalled his grandfather's story and was overcome with fear. The street leading to his house ran alongside the river. As he quickened his pace, he couldn't help but glance at the river. To his horror, he saw a figure floating on the water—a very beautiful woman with black hair, crying:

"Oh, my children! Where are my children?"

Realizing that the woman was La Llorona, the ghost from the story, the boy was paralyzed with fear. As he tried to run, a cold hand grabbed him. La Llorona pulled him into the river and drowned him in the freezing water, lamenting:

"Oh, my children!"

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कल्चर मॅक्स हा मराठी भाषेतला पहिला वहिला डिजिटल ऍप गेम आहे जो भाषाशास्त्रज्ञ अंकिता विखणकर गपचुप हिच्या संकल्पनेतून तयार झाला आहे. हा खेळ तुम्हाला तुमची भाषेची आवड जोपासण्यासाठी मदत करेल तसेच तुमची स्मरणशक्ती देखील तल्लख करेल. ह्या खेळाचा मूळ उद्देश मराठी भाषेचा प्रचार व प्रसार असून, खेळता खेळता लोकांना मराठी संस्कृतीची ओळख करून देणे हा सुद्धा आहे. वय वर्ष १३ वरील सगळे, ह्या खेळाचा आनंद लुटू शकतात. हा खेळ आपण निःशुल्क डाउनलोड करू शकता.



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1. SPANISH

**I'M ALWAYS IN A HURRY, BUT I'M NOT A CAR.
I CAN MAKE YOU LAUGH, BUT I'M NOT A STAR.
WHAT AM I?**

2. FRENCH

**I'M A PASTRY THAT'S FLAKY, BUT I'M NOT A FISH.
YOU'LL FIND ME IN A CAFÉ, IF YOU MAKE A WISH.
WHAT AM I?**

3. GERMAN

**I'M A TYPE OF CHEESE THAT'S ALWAYS IN A RUSH,
WHEN YOU ASK ME TO SLOW DOWN, I SAY, "DON'T FUSS!"
WHAT AM I?**



4. ITALIAN

**I'M A TYPE OF PASTA THAT'S NEVER IN A BIND,
WHEN YOU ASK ME TO RELAX, I SAY, "TAKE YOUR TIME!"
WHAT AM I?**



5. CHINESE

**I'M A DISH THAT'S SERVED WITH A SIDE OF FUN,
I CAN BE SPICY OR SWEET, BUT I'M ALWAYS NUMBER ONE.
WHAT AM I?**

6. JAPANESE

**I'M A TYPE OF FISH THAT SWIMS WITH DELIGHT,
WHEN YOU CATCH ME, I'M A REAL SUSHI SIGHT.
WHAT AM I?**

7. RUSSIAN

**I'M A DRINK THAT'S STRONG, BUT I'M NOT A FIGHT,
I'LL WARM YOU UP ON A COLD WINTER NIGHT.
WHAT AM I?**

8. PORTUGUESE

**I'M A FRUIT THAT'S JUICY, BUT I'M NOT A PEAR,
I'M OFTEN IN A DRINK, BUT I'M NOT A FLARE.
WHAT AM I?**



Answers will be revealed in September issue

Je ne veux pas oublier...

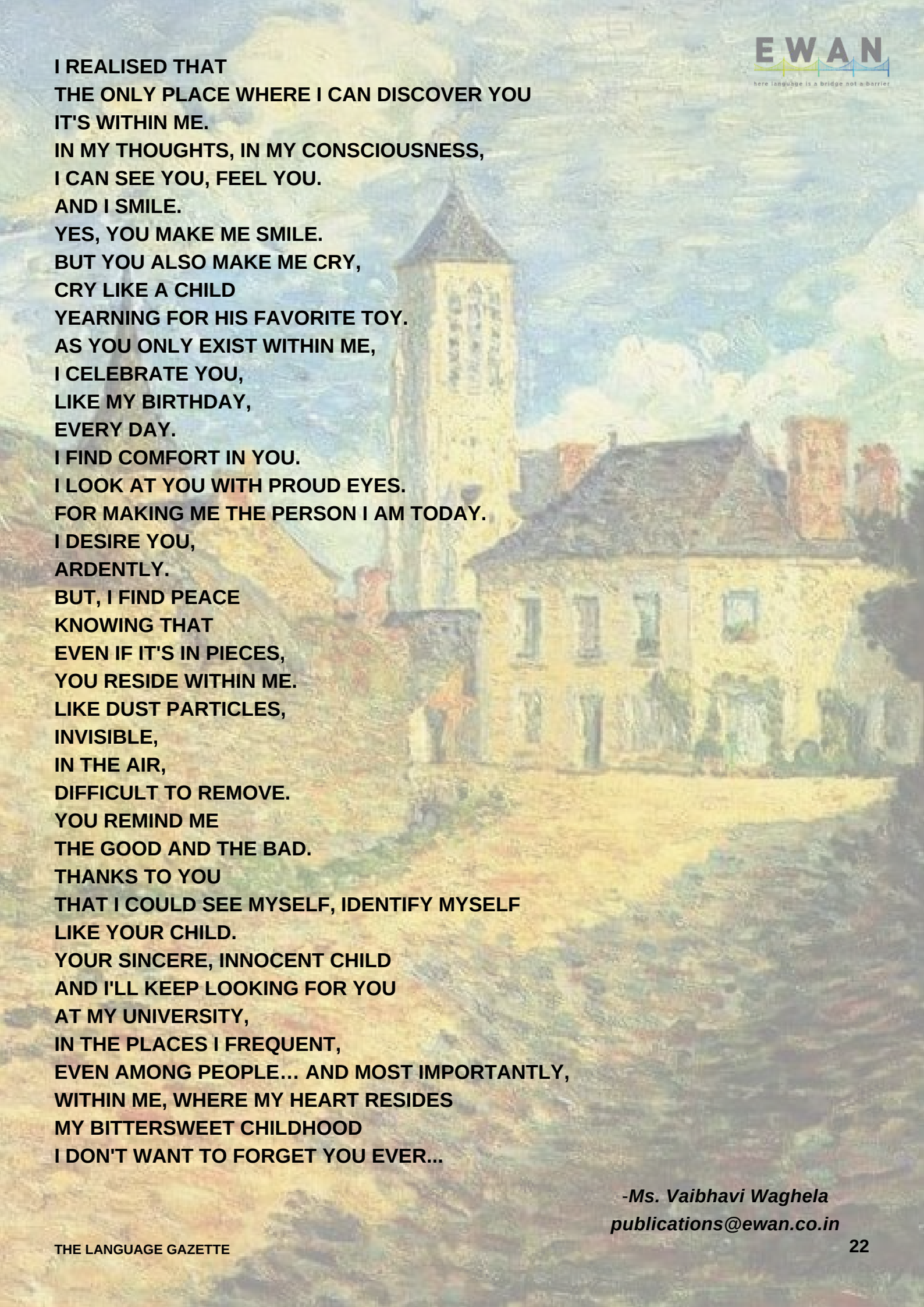
JE NE VEUX PAS OUBLIER...
MON ENFANCE.
MES RACINES.
MES TRACES.
TOUS LES PETITS MOMENTS QUI M'ONT DONNÉ VIE.
TOUS LES CHEMINS QUE J'AI SUIVIS,
DONT J'AVAIS ENVIE,
CHEZ MES GRANDS-PARENTS
OÙ J'AI VÉCU MON ENFANCE.
OÙ PEUX-JE DÉCOUVRIR LA MÊME RESSEMBLANCE ?
PARTOUT OÙ JE VAIS,
JE LA CHERCHE.
À MON UNIVERSITÉ,
AUX LIEUX QUE JE FRÉQUENTE,
MÊME CHEZ LES GENS.
MAIS JE NE TROUVE AUCUNE TRACE,
AUCUN SOUVENIR, AUCUNE GRÂCE.
QU'EST-CE QUI PEUT ME TÉLÉPORTER DANS MON ENFANCE ?
MON ENFANCE DOUCE-AMÈRE.
JE VOUS REMERCIE
DE ME DONNER CETTE VIE, CETTE ÂME, CET ESPRIT.
PUIS-JE ENCORE RAISONNER AVEC VOUS?
MON ENFANCE, JE VOUS EN PRIE.
JE VOUS PRIE DE RETOURNER.
DE ME FAIRE VIVRE LES BEAUX MOMENTS.
ENCORE UNE FOIS...
DE ME FAIRE GOÛTER LES PLAISIRS ENFANTINS.
ENCORE UNE FOIS...
DE ME FOURNIR DES CONNAISSANCES, DES VALEURS ET DES SAVOIR-FAIRE,
DE ME CORRIGER ENCORE UNE FOIS...
POUR MES NÉGLIGENCES.
QUI SUIS-JE SANS VOUS?
JE NE SUIS QU'UN CORPS,
SANS HISTOIRE, SANS VALEURS.
C'EST VOUS QUI M'AVEZ NOURRI
DE TOUT.
PENDANT VOTRE RECHERCHE,

JE ME SUIS RENDU COMPTE QUE
LE SEUL LIEU OÙ JE PEUX VOUS DÉCOUVRIR
C'EST EN MOI.
DANS MES PENSÉES, DANS MA CONSCIENCE,
JE PEUX VOUS VOIR, VOUS SENTIR.
ET JE SOURIS.
OUI, VOUS ME FAITES SOURIRE.
MAIS VOUS ME FAITES AUSSI PLEURER,
PLEURER COMME UN ENFANT
ASPIRANT À SON JOUET PRÉFÉRÉ.
COMME VOUS N'EXISTEZ QU'EN MOI,
JE VOUS CÉLÈBRE,
COMME MON ANNIVERSAIRE,
TOUS LES JOURS.
JE TROUVE DU RÉCONFORT EN VOUS.
JE VOUS REGARDE DES YEUX FIERES.
POUR ME FAIRE LA PERSONNE QUE JE SUIS AUJOURD'HUI.
JE VOUS DÉSIRE,
ARDEMMENT.
MAIS, JE TROUVE LA PAIX
EN SACHANT QUE
MÊME SI C'EST EN MORCEAUX
VOUS RESIDEZ EN MOI.
COMME LES PARTICULES DE POUSSIÈRE,
INVISIBLES,
DANS L'AIR,
DIFFICILE D'EN RETIRER.
VOUS ME RAPPELEZ
LE BIEN ET LE MAL.
C'EST GRÂCE À VOUS
QUE JE ME VOIS, M'IDENTIFIE
COMME VOTRE ENFANT.
VOTRE ENFANT SINCÈRE, INNOCENTE
ET JE CONTINUERAI DE VOUS CHERCHER,
À MON UNIVERSITÉ,
AUX LIEUX QUE JE FRÉQUENTE,
MÊME CHEZ LES GENS... ET SURTOUT
EN MOI, OÙ MON CŒUR RÉSIDE.
MON ENFANCE DOUCE-AMÈRE,
JE NE VEUX JAMAIS VOUS OUBLIER...

English Translation on next page

I don't want to forget...

I DON'T WANT TO FORGET...
 MY CHILDHOOD.
 MY ROOTS.
 MY TRACES.
 ALL THE LITTLE MOMENTS THAT GAVE ME LIFE.
 ALL THE PATHS I HAVE FOLLOWED,
 WHICH I HAVE DESIRED,
 AT MY GRANDPARENTS'
 WHERE I LIVED MY CHILDHOOD.
 WHERE CAN I DISCOVER THE SAME RESEMBLANCE?
 EVERYWHERE I GO,
 I'M LOOKING FOR HER.
 AT MY UNIVERSITY,
 IN THE PLACES I FREQUENT,
 EVEN AMONG PEOPLE.
 BUT I CAN'T FIND ANY TRACE,
 NO MEMORY, NO GRACE.
 WHAT CAN TELEPORT ME BACK TO MY CHILDHOOD?
 MY BITTERSWEET CHILDHOOD
 THANK YOU
 FOR GIVING ME THIS LIFE, THIS SOUL, THIS SPIRIT.
 CAN I STILL REASON WITH YOU?
 MY CHILDHOOD, PLEASE.
 PLEASE RETURN.
 TO MAKE ME EXPERIENCE THE BEAUTIFUL MOMENTS.
 ONCE AGAIN...
 TO MAKE ME TASTE CHILDISH PLEASURES.
 ONCE AGAIN...
 TO PROVIDE ME WITH KNOWLEDGE, VALUES AND KNOW-HOW
 TO CORRECT ME ONCE AGAIN...
 FOR MY NEGLIGENCE.
 WHO AM I WITHOUT YOU?
 I AM JUST A BODY
 WITHOUT HISTORY, WITHOUT VALUES.
 IT WAS YOU WHO FED ME
 OF EVERYTHING.
 DURING YOUR SEARCH,



I REALISED THAT
THE ONLY PLACE WHERE I CAN DISCOVER YOU
IT'S WITHIN ME.
IN MY THOUGHTS, IN MY CONSCIOUSNESS,
I CAN SEE YOU, FEEL YOU.
AND I SMILE.
YES, YOU MAKE ME SMILE.
BUT YOU ALSO MAKE ME CRY,
CRY LIKE A CHILD
YEARNING FOR HIS FAVORITE TOY.
AS YOU ONLY EXIST WITHIN ME,
I CELEBRATE YOU,
LIKE MY BIRTHDAY,
EVERY DAY.
I FIND COMFORT IN YOU.
I LOOK AT YOU WITH PROUD EYES.
FOR MAKING ME THE PERSON I AM TODAY.
I DESIRE YOU,
ARDENTLY.
BUT, I FIND PEACE
KNOWING THAT
EVEN IF IT'S IN PIECES,
YOU RESIDE WITHIN ME.
LIKE DUST PARTICLES,
INVISIBLE,
IN THE AIR,
DIFFICULT TO REMOVE.
YOU REMIND ME
THE GOOD AND THE BAD.
THANKS TO YOU
THAT I COULD SEE MYSELF, IDENTIFY MYSELF
LIKE YOUR CHILD.
YOUR SINCERE, INNOCENT CHILD
AND I'LL KEEP LOOKING FOR YOU
AT MY UNIVERSITY,
IN THE PLACES I FREQUENT,
EVEN AMONG PEOPLE... AND MOST IMPORTANTLY,
WITHIN ME, WHERE MY HEART RESIDES
MY BITTERSWEET CHILDHOOD
I DON'T WANT TO FORGET YOU EVER...

-Ms. Vaibhavi Waghela
publications@ewan.co.in

Zen Moments

**FIND YOUR ZEN IN A SINGLE BREATH.
LET THESE POEMS BE YOUR PERSONAL SANCTUARY.**

ひりょう

あのときのあの苦しみも
あのときのあの悲しみも
みんな肥料になったんだな
自分が自分になるための

**All that suffering, sadness of that time,
Everything became a fertilizer for me to become the person I am.**

ただいだけで

あなたがそこに ただいだけで
その場の 空気があかるくなる
あなたがそこに ただいだけで
みんなの心が安らぐ
そんなあなたに わたしになりたい

**Just by you being there, the atmosphere brightens up,
Just by you being there, everyone's hearts become at peace
I want to be like you.**

**Written by Aida Mitsuo
(相田 みつを)**

**Translated by Ms. Rucha Kulkarni
publication@ewan.co.in**

侘び寂び: 不完全さの中に美しさを見つける:

侘び寂びは、不完全、無常、不完全さの中に美しさを見つけることを中心とした日本の美学と世界観です。これは、人生の自然なサイクルを理解し、完璧さの追求を手放すことを奨励する哲学です。

* 不完全な庭園:



有名な茶人である千利休は、侘び寂びの中心人物です。利休は茶道の準備をしており、息子に庭を完璧に整えるよう命じたという話があります。彼の息子は注意深く砂利をかき集め、木を剪定した。しかし、利休はそれが完璧すぎると感じました。彼は意図的に桜の木を揺さぶって、自然のままの道に花びらを落としました。この行為は自然の不完全さを少し取り入れ、わびさびの精神に共鳴するシーンを作り出しました。

* 金継ぎ丼:



金継ぎは、壊れた陶器を金で修復する日本の芸術形式です。亀裂を隠すのではなく、亀裂を称賛し、ダメージをユニークな芸術作品に変えます。これは、物の歴史と変遷の中に美を見出す、侘び寂びの精神を体現しています。

English translation on next page

WABI-SABI

FINDING BEAUTY IN IMPERFECTION

Wabi-sabi is a Japanese aesthetic and worldview centered around finding beauty in imperfection, impermanence, and incompleteness. It's a philosophy that encourages us to appreciate the natural cycle of life and to let go of the pursuit of perfection.

- **The Imperfect Garden:** Sen no Rikyu, a famous tea master, is a central figure in wabi-sabi. The story goes that Rikyu was preparing a tea ceremony and tasked his son with making the garden look perfect. His son meticulously raked the gravel and pruned the trees. However, Rikyu found it too flawless. He deliberately shook a cherry blossom tree, allowing petals to fall on the pristine path. This act introduced a touch of nature's imperfection, creating a scene that resonated with wabi-sabi's spirit.



- **The Kintsugi Bowl:** Kintsugi is a Japanese art form that repairs broken pottery with gold. Instead of hiding the cracks, it celebrates them, turning damage into a unique piece of art. This embodies the wabi-sabi spirit, finding beauty in the object's history and transformation.



-Ms. Shivani Sambhus
publication@ewan.co.in

EINE NOSTALGISCHE Reise

Der Wind streift mein Herz

trägt mich zurück wo ich hingehöre

Das friedliche Zwitschern ruft mich

mich in ihren Schoß ruhen zu lassen

Dieser moschusartige Duft existiert noch

Dieser Sommerhimmel ist noch da

zeigt meine bunte Kindheit

Mein schlammiges Leben erinnert mich an mein fernes Zuhause

ruft mich zurück zu meinem ursprünglichen Kern

English translation on next page

A NOSTALGIC Trip

Wind breezing my heart

takes me back where I belong

That calmful chirps calls me back

to let me rest in their lap

That musky smell still exists

That summer sky is still there

Depicting my colourful childhood

My muddy life makes me remember my home far away

calling me back to my native core

-Mr.Omkar Dhuraji
publication@ewan.co.in

Yasuke

The African Samurai Who Shaped Japanese History

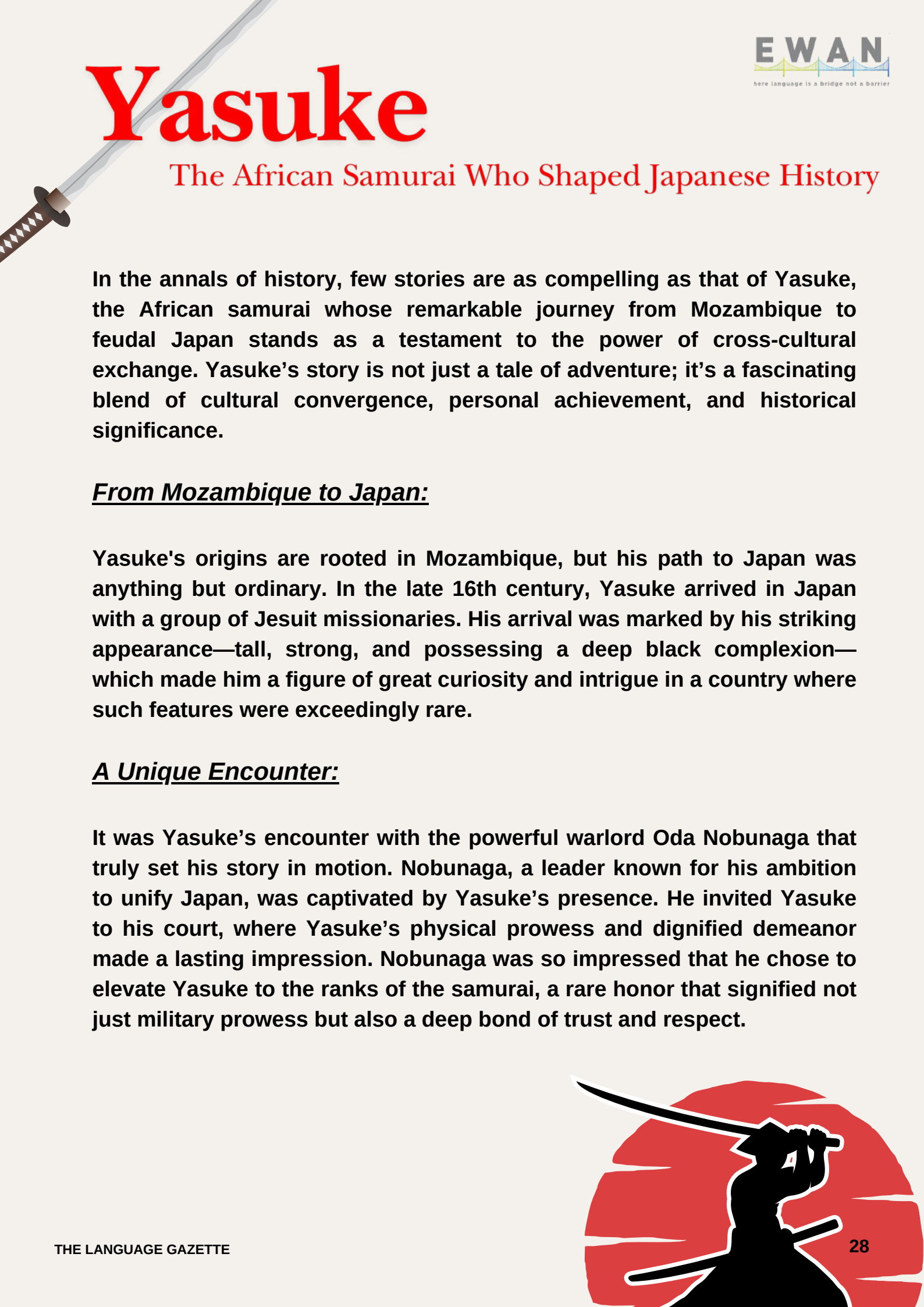
In the annals of history, few stories are as compelling as that of Yasuke, the African samurai whose remarkable journey from Mozambique to feudal Japan stands as a testament to the power of cross-cultural exchange. Yasuke's story is not just a tale of adventure; it's a fascinating blend of cultural convergence, personal achievement, and historical significance.

From Mozambique to Japan:

Yasuke's origins are rooted in Mozambique, but his path to Japan was anything but ordinary. In the late 16th century, Yasuke arrived in Japan with a group of Jesuit missionaries. His arrival was marked by his striking appearance—tall, strong, and possessing a deep black complexion—which made him a figure of great curiosity and intrigue in a country where such features were exceedingly rare.

A Unique Encounter:

It was Yasuke's encounter with the powerful warlord Oda Nobunaga that truly set his story in motion. Nobunaga, a leader known for his ambition to unify Japan, was captivated by Yasuke's presence. He invited Yasuke to his court, where Yasuke's physical prowess and dignified demeanor made a lasting impression. Nobunaga was so impressed that he chose to elevate Yasuke to the ranks of the samurai, a rare honor that signified not just military prowess but also a deep bond of trust and respect.



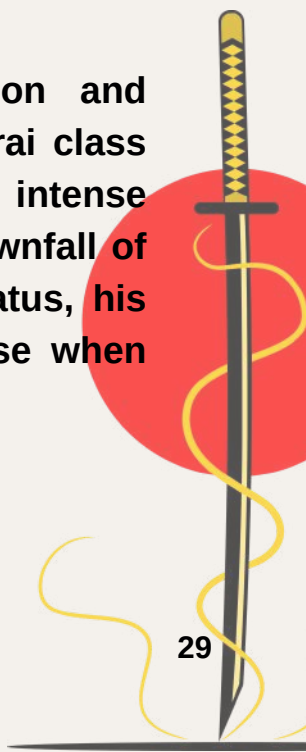


(Detail from the Sumō Yūrakuzu Byōbu, drawn in 1605. It has been suggested that the black man on the left is Yasuke.)

Samurai Life and Legacy:

As a samurai, Yasuke's duties went beyond the battlefield. He became a trusted member of Nobunaga's inner circle, participating in both military campaigns and courtly affairs. His role was a testament to his exceptional skills and Nobunaga's openness to diversity. Yasuke's presence in the samurai class was a rare integration of non-Japanese individuals into a highly exclusive warrior caste.

Yasuke's time in Japan was marked by both admiration and challenges. His presence challenged the norms of the samurai class and served as a symbol of cultural exchange in a period of intense conflict and transformation in Japan. Despite the eventual downfall of Nobunaga and the subsequent loss of Yasuke's samurai status, his story has endured as a symbol of the possibilities that arise when different cultures meet.



In popular culture, Yasuke is celebrated not only as a historical figure but also as a symbol of the potential for harmony and mutual respect between diverse cultures. His life is a powerful reminder that history is full of stories that defy expectations and celebrate the rich tapestry of human experience.

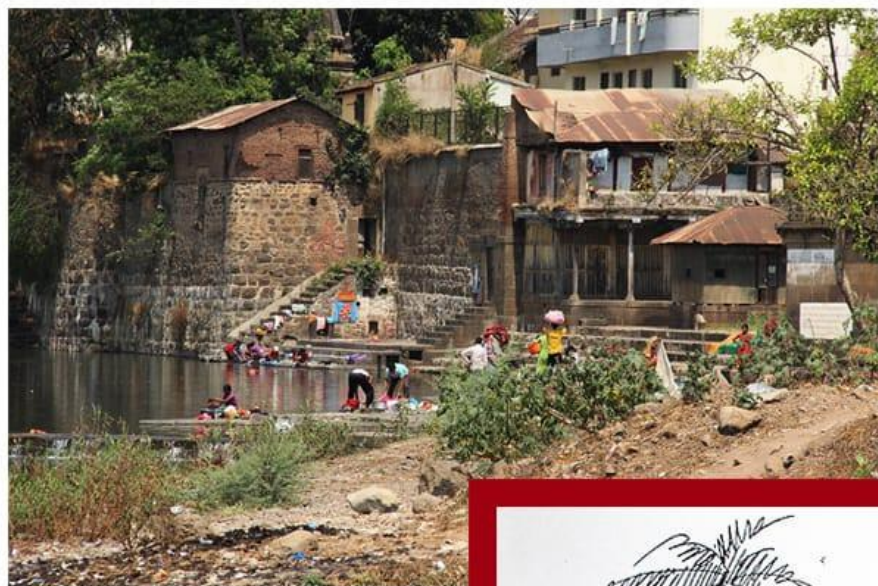
Yasuke's remarkable journey from Mozambique to becoming a samurai in Japan is a testament to the rich interplay of cultures and the enduring human spirit. His story challenges us to recognize and appreciate the diverse narratives that shape our shared history. Yasuke's legacy continues to inspire and remind us of the boundless possibilities that arise when cultures come together in the pursuit of greatness.

In recent years, Yasuke's legacy has experienced a resurgence, particularly with his inclusion in the world of video games. The new Assassin's Creed game, Assassin's Creed: Shadows, has brought Yasuke's story to a wider audience, integrating him into its rich tapestry of historical and fictional narratives. The game highlights his role as a samurai and introduces players to his extraordinary life through immersive storytelling and gameplay, bridging the gap between historical fact and interactive entertainment.

This modern reference to Yasuke not only celebrates his historical significance but also introduces his incredible story to a new generation, reinforcing his place in both historical and popular culture. The portrayal of Yasuke in Assassin's Creed reflects his enduring impact and the fascination with his remarkable journey.



(Black man on left is portrayal of Yasuke in upcoming Assassin's Creed: Shadows.)



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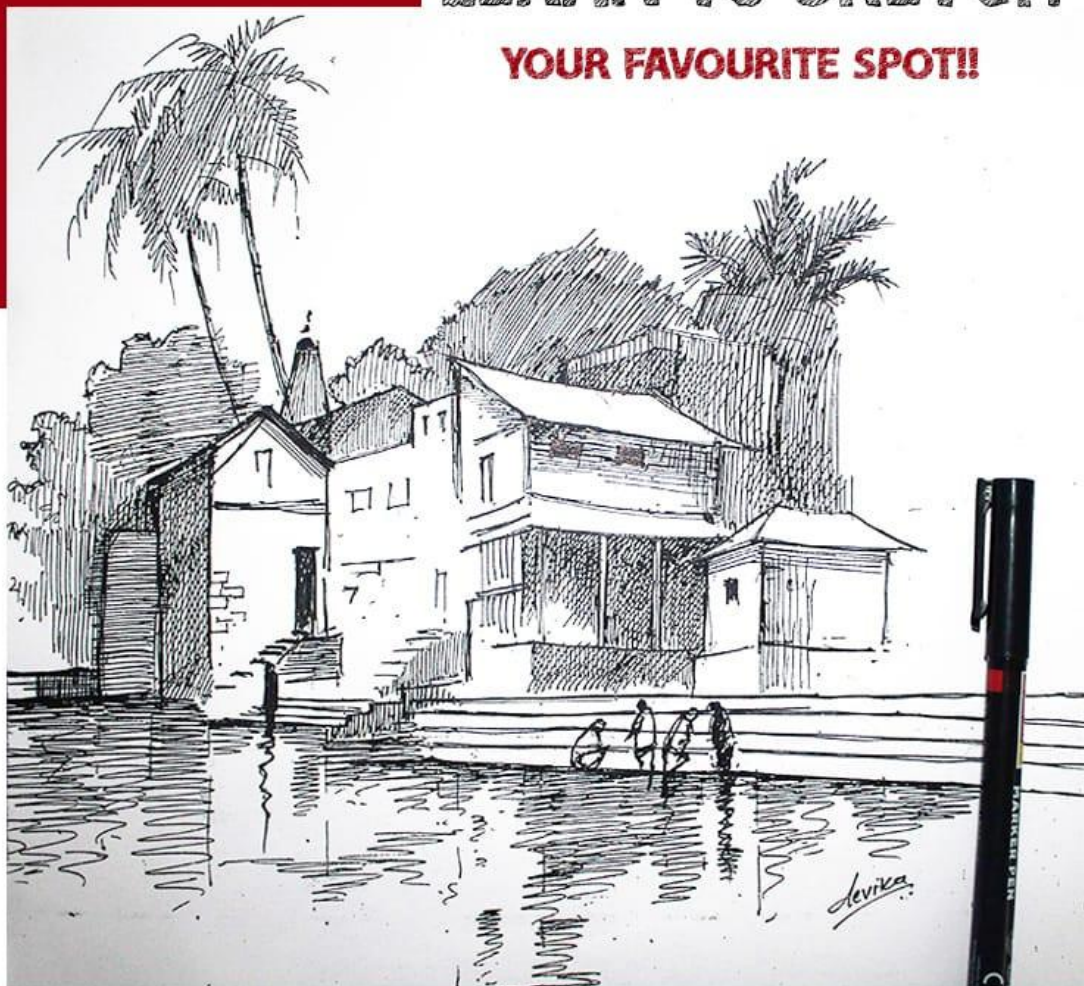


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അസ്സുറോ & സ്കൈ ബ്ലൂ: ഇറ്റലിയും അർജന്റീനയും പങ്കുവെയ്ക്കുന്ന ഗംഭീരത

RB, ഇറ്റലിയും അർജന്റീനയും തമ്മിലുള്ള സാദൃശ്യങ്ങളെക്കുറിച്ച്, പ്രത്യേകിച്ച് ഇരു രാഷ്ട്രങ്ങളും പ്രിയപ്പെട്ട നിറമായ അസ്സുറോയെക്കുറിച്ചോ അർജന്റീനയിൽ സാധാരണ കാണപ്പെടുന്ന മൃദലമായ ആകാശ നീലയെക്കുറിച്ചോ നിരന്തരം ആലോചിക്കുന്നു. ഇത് വെറും ഒരു യാദൃശ്ചികതയല്ല; ഈ രണ്ടു സംസ്കാരങ്ങളെ പരസ്പരം ബന്ധിപ്പിക്കുന്ന ഒരു നൂലുപോലെയാണ്, അവരുടെ ചരിത്രത്തിലൂടെയും, അവരുടെ ഫാഷനിലൂടെയും, തങ്ങളുടെ ദേശീയ വ്യക്തിത്വത്തിലൂടെയും പ്രോത്സാഹിപ്പിക്കുന്നു.

ഇറ്റലിയുടെ അസ്സുറോ, അതിന്റെ ദേശീയ മനസാക്ഷിയിലേക്ക് വളരെ ആഴത്തിൽ ശിലിതമായ ഒരു നിറം—സാവോയ്വിന്റെ ഹൗസിൽ നിന്നാണ് ഉത്ഭവിക്കുന്നത്, ഇത് വെറും കായിക കഴിവിനേക്കാൾ ഏറെ പരിഗണിക്കപ്പെടുന്ന ഒരു വ്യാപകമായ സാംസ്കാരിക ഗംഭീരതയെയാണ് പ്രതിനിധാനം ചെയ്യുന്നത്. വിലയേറിയ ലാപിസ് ലസുലിയിൽ നിന്ന് ഉത്ഭവിക്കുന്ന ഈ തൊണ്ണൂറ് ചരിത്രപരമായ ഗുരുത്വാകർഷണവും സമർപ്പണവും ഉൾക്കൊള്ളുന്നു. ഇത് വെറും ഒരു നിറമല്ല; അത് ഇറ്റലിയുടെ പൈതൃകത്തിന്റെ, സംസ്കാരത്തിന്റെ, അതുല്യമായ രസത്തിന്റെയും ചിഹ്നമാണ്. ഇറ്റലിയിലെ ദേശീയ ടീമുകളുടെ യൂണിഫോമുകളിൽ, ഉയർന്ന ഫാഷന്റെ സങ്കീർണ്ണമായ രൂപകൽപ്പനകളിൽ, അല്ലെങ്കിൽ ഗാഢമായ മെഡിറ്ററേനിയൻ ആകാശത്തിൽ കണ്ടാലും, അസ്സുറോ ഒരു ദേശീയ കഥാപാത്രത്തെ പ്രതിഫലിപ്പിക്കുന്നു, സൗന്ദര്യം, പാരമ്പര്യം, മികവ് എന്നിവയെ പ്രതിനിധീകരിക്കുന്നു.

ഇതുപോലെ തന്നെ, അർജന്റീനയുടെ പതാകയിൽ ശോഭിക്കുന്നതും അതിന്റെ സംസ്കാരത്തിലേക്ക് വ്യാപിക്കുന്നതുമായ സ്കൈ ബ്ലൂ തുറന്ന ചിന്തയെയും സാധ്യതകളെയും ഉദ്ദേശിക്കുന്നു. ചരിത്രം ഇറ്റലിയുടെ ചരിത്രവുമായി ഇടകലർത്തപ്പെട്ടിരിക്കുന്നു, ശതാബ്ദങ്ങളായി ദശലക്ഷക്കണക്കിന് ഇറ്റാലിയൻമാർ അർജന്റീനയിലേക്ക് കുടിയേറിയതാണ്. ഈ കുടിയേറ്റം അർജന്റീന സമൂഹത്തിൽ അതിന് മായാവിയാത്ത സ്വാധീനം ചെലുത്തിയിട്ടുണ്ട്, ഭാഷയിൽ നിന്ന് വിഭവങ്ങളിലേക്ക് വരെ സ്വാധീനിച്ചിട്ടുണ്ടല്ലോ, ശരിക്കും, ആകാശനീലയുടെ ഭാഗമായ പങ്കുവെയ്ക്കുന്ന ഈ സ്നേഹം. RB, ഇറ്റലിയിൽ ഇരുന്ന്, അർജന്റീനയിലും ഇരിക്കുന്നതുപോലെ, സമാനതകളോടൊപ്പം ആഴത്തിലുള്ള ബന്ധം, അതാണ് തന്റെ ചിന്തകളിൽ സ്ഥിരമായതാണ്. ഈ അടുക്കൾ പരസ്പരം പ്രതിഫലനം ചെയ്യുന്ന

പോലെ, അത് വെറും സാംസ്കാരികമല്ല—അതിൽ ഒരു പരമ സാന്നിധ്യം പോലും കാണപ്പെടുന്നു, ഒരൊറ്റ രാജ്യത്തിന്റെ ആത്മാവിൽ മറ്റൊന്നിന്റെ പ്രതിഫലനം കാണുന്നു.

ഇറ്റലിയിലെ അസ്സുറോയും അർജന്റീനയുടെ നീലയും വെറും നിറങ്ങൾ മാത്രമല്ല; അവ ഒരുമിച്ചുള്ള ഒരു വ്യക്തിത്വത്തിന്റെ പ്രകടനങ്ങളാണ്, അതിന്റെ ഗംഭീരത, സൃഷ്ടിപരത, ജീവിതത്തിന്റെ വിശദാംശങ്ങളെ മണ്ണിലൂടെ ഉയർത്തിക്കാട്ടുന്നതായിരിക്കുന്നു. ഇരു രാജ്യങ്ങളും ഫാഷന്റെ വൈഭവം പങ്കിടുന്നു, ആ നിറം തങ്ങളുടെ വസ്ത്രസമ്പത്തിൽ ഒരു സ്ഥിരം ഭാഗമാണ്, പാരമ്പര്യവും ആധുനികതയും മിശ്രിതമാക്കിയ ഡിസൈനിന്റെ ഉത്പാദനങ്ങളിൽ. തങ്ങളുടെ വിഭവങ്ങളിലെ പാചകപ്രപഞ്ചത്തിൽ, അതേ ശൈലി പ്രയോഗിക്കുന്നു—അതോ ഒരു ഇറ്റാലിയൻ പാസ്ത ഡിസായാലോ, അല്ലെങ്കിൽ ഒരു അർജന്റീന ആസാദോ ആയാലോ, പാചകം പ്രകാശത്തിലും വ്യക്തികങ്ങളിലും ഒപ്പം സമർപ്പണത്തിലും സൂക്ഷ്മതയിൽ പതിഞ്ഞിരിക്കുന്നു, ഗുണനിലവാരവും രുചിയും പ്രധാനമായിത്തീർന്നിരിക്കുകയാണ്.

ചിന്തകളിലും സാംസ്കാരിക പ്രകടനങ്ങളിലും ഇറ്റലിക്കാരും അർജന്റീനക്കാർക്കും ഒരു സ്വാഭാവികമാ.

English Translation on next page

Azzurro & Sky Blue: The Elegance of Italy and Argentina's Shared Hue

RB often reflects on the striking similarities between Italy and Argentina, particularly when it comes to the colour that both nations hold dear—azzurro in Italy and the soft sky blue often seen in Argentina. This shared hue isn't just a coincidence; it's a thread that ties the two cultures together, weaving through their history, their fashion, and even their national identities.

Italy's Azzurro a colour so deeply ingrained in its national psyche—originates from the House of Savoy and has come to represent not just athletic prowess but a broader cultural elegance. The shade, derived from the precious lapis lazuli, carries with it a sense of historical gravitas and refined taste. It's more than just a colour; it's a symbol of Italy's heritage, sophistication, and the effortless style that the nation is known for. Whether seen in the uniforms of Italy's national teams, the intricate designs of high fashion, or the deep Mediterranean skies, azzurro reflects a national character that values beauty, tradition, and excellence.

Similarly, in Argentina, the sky blue that adorns its flag and permeates its culture evokes a sense of openness and possibility. Argentina's history is intertwined with that of Italy, with millions of Italians having emigrated to Argentina over the past centuries. This migration has left an indelible mark on Argentine society, influencing everything from the language to the cuisine, and indeed, the shared love for the colour blue. RB often feels a deep connection between the two countries, sensing that when he is in Italy, he is also in Argentina, and vice versa. This affinity is more than just cultural—it's almost visceral, as if the two nations are reflections of each other across the ocean.

The Azzurro of Italy and the blue of Argentina are more than just colours; they are expressions of a collective identity that celebrates elegance, creativity, and an appreciation for life's finer details. Both countries have a flair for fashion, where the colour is a staple in wardrobes that blend tradition with cutting-edge design. In their cuisine, the same artistic sensibility applies—whether it's an Italian pasta dish or an Argentine asado, the approach to cooking is both passionate and meticulous, valuing quality and flavor above all else.

In terms of thinking and cultural expression, both Italians and Argentinians have a natural inclination towards innovation and style. This is evident in the arts, literature, and even in daily life, where the pursuit of beauty and excellence is a shared value. The blue that runs through the heart of both nations symbolizes a sky without limits—a reminder that creativity and ambition can elevate the everyday into something extraordinary.

For RB, the connection between Italy and Argentina is beautifully encapsulated in the shared love for the colour blue. It's a reminder that, despite the physical distance, the two countries are bound by a common spirit—a spirit that values elegance, celebrates beauty, and embraces the boundless possibilities that life offers.

RB is abbreviation for Racket Boy, which refers to the author himself

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Prognose: Dit is wat de energietransitie betekent voor de elektriciteitsprijzen

Elektriciteit is een belangrijke locatie- en kostenfactor voor de industrie in Duitsland. De aanhoudende, enorm dure energietransitie wakkert in veel sectoren de zorgen aan over de enorm stijgende energieprijzen. Marktwaarnemers en onderzoeken komen tot een andere langetermijnvoorspelling.

Wat is de energietransitie?

Duitsland wil afstappen van de duidelijke dominantie van koolwaterstof- en kernenergiebronnen en naar een koolstofarme en kernenergievrije economie, gebaseerd op het gebruik van hernieuwbare energiebronnen. Dit project staat bekend als de energietransitie. De oorsprong ervan ligt in de milieu- en anti-kernenergiebeweging van de jaren zeventig.

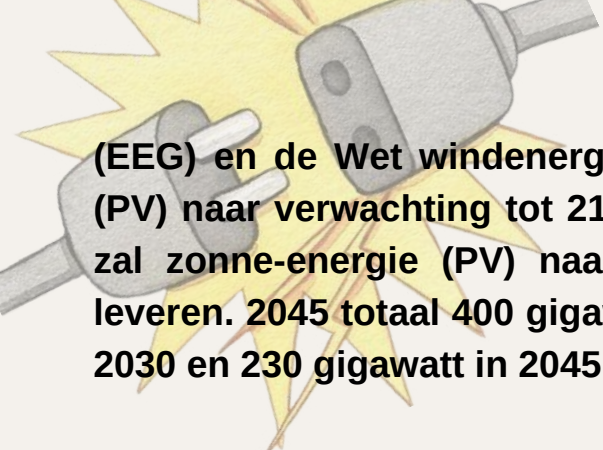
Het vooruitzicht van de geleidelijke afschaffing van de energieproductie met ruwe olie, steenkool, aardgas en kernenergie werd in 2000 een concreet politiek doel. Destijds kwam de federale regering met Duitse energiebedrijven overeen om voor het eerst kernenergie uit te faseren. In 2023 zullen eindelijk de laatste reactoren in dit land van het elektriciteitsnet worden gehaald. Bovendien heeft Duitsland zich er wettelijk toe verplicht om uiterlijk in 2038 de kolengestookte elektriciteitsopwekking te beëindigen. Het plan is om de uitstoot van het schadelijke broeikasgas CO₂ te verminderen en de Bondsrepubliek tegen 2045 klimaatneutraal te maken.

Hoe ver is de energietransitie?

De energietransitie moet in de eerste plaats slagen door de uitbreiding van hernieuwbare energiebronnen (RE). Daartoe stimuleert de federale overheid de bouw en het gebruik van emissievrije zonne- en windenergiecentrales – op het land (onshore) en voor de kust (offshore). In 2030 moet 80 procent van de elektriciteit die in Duitsland wordt opgewekt uit hernieuwbare bronnen komen.

Volgens het Federal Network Agency bedroeg het bruto geïnstalleerd vermogen van zonne-energie, windenergie op land en op zee en biomassa in 2023 ongeveer 160 gigawatt. Dit kwam overeen met 56 procent van de totale elektriciteitsopwekking. Er moet echter nog veel worden gedaan om de doelstellingen van de Wet op hernieuwbare energiebronnen





(EEG) en de Wet windenergie op zee te bereiken: in 2030 zal zonne-energie (PV) naar verwachting tot 215 gigawatt aan elektriciteit leveren en tegen 2030 zal zonne-energie (PV) naar verwachting tot 215 gigawatt aan elektriciteit leveren. 2045 totaal 400 gigawatt. Het doel voor windenergie is 145 gigawatt in 2030 en 230 gigawatt in 2045.

En wat is de huidige situatie met broeikasgassen? Volgens onderzoek van Agora Energiewende – een denktank en lobbyorganisatie in de energiesector – werd in 2023 in Duitsland 673 miljoen ton CO₂ geproduceerd. Vergeleken met de waarde van het referentiejaar 1990 is dit een daling van 46 procent. Vanuit het standpunt van Agora Energiewende zijn twee factoren hiervoor in essentie verantwoordelijk.

- De elektriciteitsopwekking uit steenkool daalde naar het laagste niveau sinds de jaren vijftig. Hiermee werd 44 miljoen ton CO₂ bespaard.
- Er was een crisis- en economisch gerelateerde daling van de productie in energie-intensieve Duitse bedrijven.

Vooraf uit het tweede punt blijkt dat de CO₂-reductie deels te danken is aan een tragere economische ontwikkeling. Als het ondernemingsklimaat verbetert, zal dit effect waarschijnlijk afnemen. En: De daling van de CO₂-uitstoot door gebouwen (warmte en koude) en door transport stagneerde in 2023 vrijwel. Simon Müller, directeur van Agora Energiewende Duitsland, roept daarom op tot “adequate randvoorwaarden voor de industrie om in Duitsland te kunnen investeren – bijvoorbeeld in klimaatneutrale staalproductie en de overstap van gas naar elektriciteit voor proceswarmte.” Bouwsector pleit hij voor een consistente implementatie van besloten maatregelen. Als het om transport gaat, vraagt het om fundamentele politieke beslissingen ten gunste van klimaatvriendelijke mobiliteit.

Vooruitzichten: Hoe ontwikkelt de prijs van elektriciteit zich?

Overstappen op duurzame energie kost veel geld. Een modelberekening van het ifo Instituut komt tot deze conclusie: “De cumulatieve systemische meerkosten voor de energietransitie in 2050 bedragen tussen de 500 miljard euro en ruim 3.000 miljard euro, afhankelijk van de randvoorwaarden. Dit komt overeen met gemiddeld 0,4 tot 2,5 procent van het Duitse bruto binnenlands product vanaf 2018 per jaar.”

Welke invloed heeft dit op de industriële elektriciteitsprijs? Voor veel bedrijven is dit een belangrijke vraag. Feit is: vergeleken met 2021 is de prijs van industriële elektriciteit in 2022 ruim verdubbeld (102,1 procent). Dit was grotendeels te wijten aan de Russische aanval op Oekraïne, die voor grote onzekerheid op de internationale energiemarkt zorgde en daarmee voor een aanzienlijke prijsstijging. De situatie met betrekking tot de energie-inkoopkosten is inmiddels gekalmeerd.

Het marktonderzoeksinstituut ibis World heeft de afgelopen jaren de situatie in Duitsland geobserveerd. Het resultaat: “Sinds 2019 is de industriële elektriciteitsprijs met gemiddeld 0,6 procent per jaar gedaald, zodat deze in 2024 17,9 eurocent per kWh moet bedragen. Dit betekent opnieuw een verlaging van 27% vergeleken met de prijs van vorig jaar.”

En welke verdere ontwikkeling? Zal de energietransitie de elektriciteitsprijs doen stijgen? Medio 2021 presenteerde het Fraunhofer Instituut voor Zonnenergiesystemen (ISE) hierover een onderzoek. Dienovereenkomstig zullen de elektriciteitsproductiekosten van hernieuwbare energiebronnen in de toekomst goedkoper zijn dan die van conventionele elektriciteitsproductie.

Dat komt volgens het onderzoek onder meer door de stijgende CO₂-prijs, die in 2030 ruim 100 euro per ton zou kunnen bedragen. Dit maakt het opwekken van elektriciteit in fossiele energiecentrales duur in vergelijking met hernieuwbare energiebronnen. Bedrijven zullen daarom waarschijnlijk meer investeren in nieuwe duurzame energiesystemen. Op voorwaarde dat “er voldoende ruimte en energiecentralecapaciteit beschikbaar is voor wind- en zonne-energie”, zegt projectmanager Dr. Christoph Kost. De ISE-prijsvoorspelling voor zonnepanelen: In 2040 zullen de elektriciteitsproductiekosten waarschijnlijk tussen 3,58 en 6,77 cent/kWh liggen voor kleine PV-daksystemen en tussen 1,92 en 3,51 cent/kWh voor op de grond gemonteerde systemen. En het gaat verder: “In 2030 zou de elektriciteitsopwekking uit een PV-batterijsysteem goedkoper kunnen zijn dan uit een gas- en stoomkrachtcentrale. In 2040 kunnen zelfs kleine PV-batterijsystemen elektriciteitsopwekkingskosten realiseren van tussen de 5 en 12 cent/kWh.” Ter vergelijking: medio mei 2024 kostte industriële elektriciteit in Duitsland 17,9 cent/kWh, zoals voorspeld door ibis World.

English Translation on next page





Forecast: This is what the energy transition means for electricity prices

Electricity is an important location and cost factor for industry in Germany. The ongoing, enormously expensive energy transition is fueling concerns in many sectors about immensely rising energy prices. Market observers and studies have reached a different long-term forecast.

What is the energy transition?

Germany wants to move away from the clear dominance of hydrocarbon and nuclear energy sources and towards a low-carbon and nuclear-free economy based on the use of renewable energy sources. This project is called the energy transition. Its origins lie in the environmental and anti-nuclear movement of the 1970s.

The concrete political goal was the long-term phase-out of energy production using oil, coal, natural gas and nuclear power in 2000. At that time, the federal government and German energy companies agreed to phase out nuclear power for the first time. The last reactors in this country will finally be taken off the grid in 2023. In addition, Germany has legally committed itself to ending coal-fired power generation by 2038 at the latest. This is also based on the plan to reduce emissions of the harmful greenhouse gas CO₂ and to make the Federal Republic climate-neutral by 2045.

How far has the energy transition progressed?

The energy transition is to be successful primarily through the expansion of renewable energies (RE). To this end, the federal government is driving forward the construction and use of emission-free solar and wind power plants – on land (onshore) and offshore. By 2030, 80 percent of the electricity generated in Germany is to come from renewable sources. According to the Federal Network Agency, the gross installed capacity of solar energy, onshore and offshore wind energy, and biomass was around 160 gigawatts in 2023. This corresponds to 56 percent of total electricity generation. However, there is still a lot to do to achieve the targets under the Renewable Energy Sources Act (EEG) and the Offshore Wind Energy Act: solar energy (PV) is expected to supply up to 215 gigawatts of electricity

by 2030 and a total of 400 gigawatts by 2045. For wind energy, 145 gigawatts are targeted by 2030 and 230 gigawatts by 2045.

And what is the current situation with greenhouse gases? According to studies by Agora Energiewende – a think tank and lobby organization in the energy sector – 673 million tons of CO₂ were produced in Germany in 2023. Compared to the value for the reference year 1990, this is a decrease of 46 percent. From Agora Energiewende's point of view, two factors are largely responsible for this.

- Electricity generation from coal fell to its lowest level since the 1950s, saving 44 million tonnes of CO₂.
- There was a crisis- and economic downturn-related decline in production in energy-intensive German companies.

The second point in particular shows that the reduction in CO₂ is partly due to a slowdown in economic development. If the business climate improves, this effect should diminish. And: the decline in CO₂ emissions from buildings (heating and cooling) and from transport almost stagnated in 2023.

Simon Müller, director of Agora Energiewende Deutschland, is therefore calling for “adequate framework conditions for industry to be able to invest in Germany – for example in climate-neutral steel production and the switch from gas to electricity for process heat.” In the area of buildings, he is calling for consistent implementation of the measures decided upon. In the area of transport, he is calling for fundamental political decisions in favor of climate-friendly mobility.

Outlook: How will electricity prices develop?

The switch to renewable energy costs a lot of money. A model calculation by the ifo Institute comes to this conclusion: “The cumulative systemic additional costs for the energy transition by 2050 are between 500 billion euros and more than 3,000 billion euros, depending on the conditions. This corresponds to an average of 0.4 to 2.5 percent of Germany's gross domestic product in 2018 per year.”

How does this affect the price of industrial electricity? This is an important question for many companies. The fact is: compared to 2021, the price of industrial electricity more than doubled in 2022 (102.1 percent). This was largely due to Russia's attack on Ukraine, which caused great uncertainty on the international energy market and thus a significant increase in prices. The situation with regard to energy procurement costs has now calmed down.

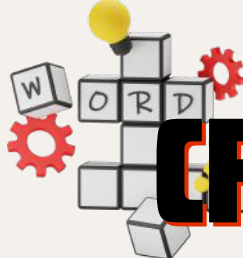
The ibis WorldMarket Research Institute observed the situation in Germany over the past few years. The result: "Since 2019, the industrial electricity price has fallen by an average of 0.6 percent per year, so that in 2024 it should amount to 17.9 euro cents per kWh. This in turn corresponds to a reduction of 27% compared to the previous year's price." And what about future developments? Will the energy transition drive up electricity prices? The Fraunhofer Institute for Solar Energy Systems (ISE) presented a study on this in mid-2021. According to the study, the electricity generation costs of renewable energies will be cheaper in the future than those of conventional electricity production.

According to the study, this is due, among other things, to the rising price of CO₂, which could be more than 100 euros per tonne in 2030. This makes electricity generation in fossil power plants more expensive than renewable energies. Companies are therefore likely to invest more in new renewable energy plants. Provided "that sufficient space and power plant capacities are available for wind and PV," says project manager Dr. Christoph Kost.

The ISE price forecast for solar systems: In 2040, the electricity generation costs are expected to be between 3.58 and 6.77 cents/kWh for small PV roof systems and between 1.92 and 3.51 cents/kWh for open-space systems. It goes on to say: "In 2030, electricity generation from a PV battery system could then be cheaper than from a combined cycle power plant. In 2040, even small PV battery systems can then achieve electricity generation costs of between 5 and 12 cents/kWh."

For comparison: In mid-May 2024, industrial electricity in Germany cost 17.9 cents/kWh – as predicted by ibis World.

-Ms. Aisha Busari
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CROSSWORD

Countries & Capitals

ANSWERS

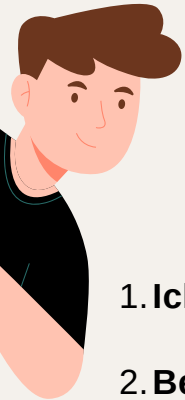
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The Word Detective

Can you crack the code ?

Answers !



- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1. Ich spiele 兄と サッカーをします hermano | 1. I play football with my brother. |
| 2. Bebo おちゃ regelmäßig | 2. I drink tea regularly. |
| 3. Wir sehen una película えいがかん | 3. We are watching a movie in theatre |
| 4. Ese coche ist はやいです | 4. That Car is so fast. |
| 5. दिवाळी es まつり der Lichter | 5. Diwali is festival of lights. |
| 6. Me gusta trinke コーラ | 6. I like drinking Coke. |
| 7. Ich habe rojo じてんしゃ | 7. I have a red bicycle. |
| 8. El gato ねています auf dem Sofa | 8. The cat is sleeping on the couch. |
| 9. Die Sonne brilla かがやいています | 9. The sun is shining brightly. |
| 10. かれは compró ein neues Auto | 10. He bought a new car |





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